



FREE GUIDE · TO THE SKY

7 social media strategies that bring you **real customers**, not just likes.

Short and clear. No jargon, no theory. Only what actually works in 2026 for a business that wants sales, not applause. With ready-made hooks and a cheat-sheet you can use today.

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7 strategies + hooks + cheat-sheet

Likes don't pay your bills.

Plenty of businesses post a lot and get little back: a few hearts, zero customers. The difference isn't „more content", it's content built to sell. Below are the 7 things we do for our clients that you can start applying tomorrow. At the end you also get ready-made hooks and a cheat-sheet.

1

Talk to one single person

„For everyone" means for no one. Picture one ideal customer and write to them, like to a friend. A clear message for someone specific convinces far more than a correct message for everybody.

The trick: start with „If you're a [their job]..." and you've caught exactly who you want.

2

The first 3 seconds decide everything

On Reels, TikTok and Shorts, people decide in under 2 seconds whether they stay or scroll. Don't start with „hi, today I want to talk about...". Start with the hook: a question, a real problem, a result or a statement that breaks the pattern. You get 6 ready-made hook types on page 4.

The number: you need over 70% of people to stay in the first 3 seconds, or the algorithm won't push the clip.

3

Give value, not just ads

Teach, help, show behind the scenes. Simple rule: out of 5 posts, 4 give something useful and 1 sells directly. People buy from those they trust, and trust is earned by helping, not by saying „buy now".

4

Consistent beats perfect

Better 3 good posts a week, every week, than 10 perfect ones today and nothing for a month. The algorithm and people reward rhythm. Build a simple calendar and stick to it.

5

Short vertical video is king

In 2026, short vertical video (9:16) brings by far the most organic reach. You don't need a film crew: a phone, good light, a clear message. And always add captions: most people watch with the sound off.

The number: captions boost watch time by up to 86%. 6 in 10 people watch on mute.

6

Turn comments into customers (automatically)

The most powerful trick few people use: instead of „link in bio", put „comment GUIDE and I'll send it" in your post. A tool (like ManyChat) automatically sends a private message with your link to everyone who comments. Non-stop, even at night.

The number: private messages get over 90% open rate, far above any email.

7

Watch the numbers that matter

Don't get fooled by likes. Track what brings money: messages, enquiries, sales, cost per lead. Double down on what works, cut what doesn't. That's the difference between „we're active" and „we're growing".

Bonus: combine organic with paid ads. Good content builds trust, ads put it fast in front of the right people. Together, they grow much faster than apart.

8 ready-made hooks that stop the scroll.

Replace the brackets with your business. These are the patterns that land most often in 2026.

WHO YOU ARE (TARGETING)

„If you're a [their job] struggling with [problem], give me 20 seconds."

RESULT FIRST

„How I got [result] in [time], without [the classic method they hate]."

BREAK THE PATTERN

„Everyone thinks [X] is the problem. It's not. The real reason is [Y]."

LOSS AVERSION

„This mistake is costing you customers every day and you can't even see it."

CURIOSITY

„I did [thing] wrong for 6 months. The fix took 20 minutes."

USEFUL LIST

„3 things my best clients do and the rest don't."

DIRECT PROBLEM

„Posting daily and still no sales? Here's what's missing."

BEHIND THE SCENES

„This is what a day looks like when we bring [result] for a real client."

Golden rule: the hook has to work with the sound off. Put it big on screen, 4-7 words, in the first second.

The recipe for a video that sells.

Every good clip has the same backbone. Keep it and you can't go wrong.

0-3 sec

Hook

Stop the scroll. A question, problem, result or something that breaks the pattern.

3-20 sec

Value

Deliver the promise in 2-3 clear steps. No dead time, no jargon.

End

Payoff

The useful takeaway or result. They leave with something in hand.

End

One step

A single clear instruction: „comment [word]“, „save“, „message us“.

3 simple patterns, depending on your goal:

PAS · when you want to hit a pain

Problem → Agitate (show how bad it is) → your Solution. Perfect for services.

AIDA · when you want a fast sale

Attention → Interest → Desire → Action. Great for a concrete offer.

Before → After → Bridge · when you have a transformation

How it was → how it is now → how you get there too. Gold for products and results.

A video under 90 seconds gets, on average, over 50% more engagement. Short and dense beats long and diluted.

Visual cheat-sheet 2026.

The sizes and basic rules so your posts look professional on a phone.

Format	Size	When to use it
Reels / TikTok / Shorts	1080 × 1920 (9:16)	Reach and new customers. Vertical is a must.
Instagram post / carousel	1080 × 1350 (4:5)	Takes up more screen than a square.
Carousel (8-10 slides)	4:5 or square	Best engagement. First slide = 80% of the job.

Quick rules:



Safe zone: keep the important text in the center (70-80%). The top and bottom get covered by app buttons.



High contrast: white text on a dark background (or the other way around). Readable at a glance, on the street, in the sun.



How often: don't overdo it. Max 1-2 posts a day on Instagram. More than that and the algorithm cuts your reach.



Always caption: most people watch without sound. No captions = you lose half your audience.



NEXT STEP

Want us to do **this** for you?

We're To The Sky. We build ads and websites for businesses in Romania and Moldova that want more customers, not just likes. We explain things in plain language, you work directly with us, and we measure one thing: the money you make.

Let's look at your business together. **Free audit, zero contract.** We tell you clearly what works, what doesn't and what we'd change first.

Get your free audit at tothesky.online

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